

IELTS Global Issues Vocabulary

69 words for Band 5.5 → 6.5+ | Environment · Conflict · Economics · Politics · Health

#	Word	POS	Definition
1	aids	<i>n.</i>	Acquired Immune Deficiency Syndrome; a disease caused by HIV
2	alliance	<i>n.</i>	A union or agreement between countries/groups for mutual benefit
3	asylum	<i>n.</i>	Protection given by a state to someone who has left their home country as a refugee
4	carbon	<i>n.</i>	A chemical element; used in 'carbon emissions' and 'carbon footprint'
5	censorship	<i>n.</i>	The suppression or control of speech, media, or other communication
6	colonial	<i>adj.</i>	Relating to a colony or colonialism
7	colonialism	<i>n.</i>	The policy of acquiring and maintaining colonies for economic/political control
8	colonist	<i>n.</i>	A settler in or inhabitant of a colony
9	colony	<i>n.</i>	A country or area under political control of another country
10	deficit	<i>n.</i>	The amount by which spending exceeds income; a shortage (e.g. trade deficit)
11	deluge	<i>n.</i>	A severe flood or heavy rainfall; an overwhelming quantity
12	depletion	<i>n.</i>	Reduction in the quantity of a resource; exhaustion
13	dictator	<i>n.</i>	A ruler with total power over a country, typically one who obtained it by force
14	dictatorship	<i>n.</i>	A system of government by a dictator
15	diplomacy	<i>n.</i>	The management of international relations by negotiation
16	diplomat	<i>n.</i>	An official representing a country abroad
17	diplomatic	<i>adj.</i>	Relating to diplomacy or international relations
18	disarm	<i>v.</i>	To take away weapons; to reduce a country's armed forces
19	dole	<i>n.</i>	Unemployment benefit paid by the government
20	drought	<i>n.</i>	A prolonged period of abnormally low rainfall; a shortage of water
21	ecosystem	<i>n.</i>	A biological community of organisms interacting with their environment
22	emission	<i>n.</i>	The production and release of gas (especially greenhouse gases) into the atmosphere
23	ethnic	<i>adj.</i>	Relating to a group of people sharing a common national or cultural tradition
24	exploitation	<i>n.</i>	The action of treating someone unfairly for one's own benefit
25	extinct	<i>adj.</i>	No longer in existence; having died out (of a species)

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26	extinction	<i>n.</i>	The state of being extinct; the dying out of a species
27	genocide	<i>n.</i>	The deliberate killing of a large group of people of a particular nation or ethnicity
28	globalization	<i>n.</i>	The process by which businesses and cultures spread worldwide
29	greenhouse	<i>n./adj.</i>	A glass building for plants; used in 'greenhouse effect/gas'
30	humanism	<i>n.</i>	A philosophy that emphasises human rather than divine matters; humanitarianism
31	humanitarian	<i>adj./n.</i>	Concerned with human welfare; a person who promotes human welfare
32	hurricane	<i>n.</i>	A tropical storm with very strong, fast winds
33	imperialism	<i>n.</i>	A policy of extending a country's power through colonisation or force
34	imperialist	<i>n.</i>	A person who supports imperialism
35	indigenous	<i>adj.</i>	Originating or occurring naturally in a particular place; native
36	infectious	<i>adj.</i>	Capable of spreading from one person to another; contagious
37	inflation	<i>n.</i>	A general increase in prices and fall in purchasing value of money
38	layoff	<i>n.</i>	A discharge of workers, especially temporary; redundancy
39	malaria	<i>n.</i>	A disease transmitted by mosquitoes, common in tropical areas
40	malnutrition	<i>n.</i>	Lack of proper nutrition caused by insufficient or unbalanced diet
41	mandate	<i>n.</i>	An official order or authority given to carry out a policy
42	martial	<i>adj.</i>	Relating to war or the military (e.g. martial law)
43	migrant	<i>n.</i>	A person who moves to a different place, especially for work
44	migration	<i>n.</i>	The movement of people from one place to another to live/work
45	missile	<i>n.</i>	A weapon that is fired or thrown at a target
46	monopolize	<i>v.</i>	To take exclusive control of a trade, commodity, or market
47	monopoly	<i>n.</i>	Exclusive control of the supply of a product or service
48	ozone	<i>n.</i>	A gas in the upper atmosphere that protects Earth from UV radiation
49	penury	<i>n.</i>	Extreme poverty; destitution
50	petroleum	<i>n.</i>	Crude oil; a liquid found underground used as fuel
51	pollutant	<i>n.</i>	A substance that pollutes the environment
52	propaganda	<i>n.</i>	Biased information spread to promote a political cause or point of view
53	protocol	<i>n.</i>	The official rules of diplomatic etiquette; an international agreement

#	Word	POS	Definition
54	racism	<i>n.</i>	Prejudice and discrimination against a person based on their race
55	recycle	<i>v.</i>	To convert waste into reusable material
56	referendum	<i>n.</i>	A direct vote by the public on a political question
57	renewable	<i>adj.</i>	Capable of being replenished naturally (e.g. renewable energy)
58	sanction	<i>n./v.</i>	An official penalty imposed on a country; to authorise or approve
59	scarcity	<i>n.</i>	Insufficiency of supply; a lack of something
60	segregate	<i>v.</i>	To separate people based on race, sex, or religion
61	seismic	<i>adj.</i>	Relating to earthquakes; of great magnitude or effect
62	skirmish	<i>n.</i>	A minor, brief military conflict or argument
63	sovereign	<i>adj./n.</i>	Having supreme authority; an independent state
64	sovereignty	<i>n.</i>	Supreme power or authority; the right of a state to govern itself
65	starvation	<i>n.</i>	Suffering or death caused by lack of food
66	strife	<i>n.</i>	Angry or bitter conflict; struggle
67	subsidy	<i>n.</i>	Money given by a government to support an industry or activity
68	tariff	<i>n.</i>	A tax on imported goods
69	unemployment	<i>n.</i>	The state of being without a paid job

Topics: environment & climate · conflict & security · economics & trade · politics & governance · health & migration